

THE MAN IN THE RED BANDANA

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

INTRO: Anyone who was alive on September 11, 2001 remembers where they were and what they were doing when they learned that radical religious madmen had flown two airliners into the World Trade Center. One into the Pentagon, and one into the ground in Pennsylvania. On that infamous day:

- 2,735 civilians died in the World Trade Center...
- 87 Passengers and crew aboard American Airlines Flight 111 perished...
- 60 passengers and crew aboard Delta flight 175 left this earth...
- 125 people in the Pentagon died...

- 64 passengers aboard American Airlines Flight 77 were killed...
- 36 brave passengers aboard United Flight 93 gave up their lives over Pennsylvania, probably preventing a tragedy that would have ended at the White House...
- 23 New York City law enforcement officers; 37 Port Authority police officers; 47 Port Authority workers; and 343 New York City firefighters and rescue workers were killed in the rescue effort...

All total 3,557 rescue workers and citizens stepped into eternity on that horrific day!
(HAVE A MOMENT OF SILENCE FOR THE FALLEN)

(ASK ALL FIRST RESPONDERS TO
STAND AND GIVE APPLAUSE FOR
THEM)

In addition, 19 radical religious cowards
went to hell in their plan, driven by hatred
toward innocent people!

Twenty-One years-ago today, inside the
World Trade Center, a horrific scene
developed as a group of individuals sat
bloody and terrified -- the lights out, smoke
engulfing the room and pain searing through
their bodies. As far as they knew, there was
no escape from where they were, in the
South Tower. The room they were in lay in
pieces after being hit by Delta Flight 175.

**(PLACE THE GRAPHIC AND THE
TITLE OF THE SERMON ON THE
SCREEN AT THIS TIME)**

Then out of nowhere, a young man wearing a red bandana burst in and took control. In a strong, authoritative voice, he let them know he had discovered an obscure stairway. He led them through the darkness, over the wreckage, and down the stairwell, all the while, instructing the healthy to assist the injured.

This man in the red bandana made several trips up and down the tower that day rescuing people he did not know!

The man in the red bandana was not a fire fighter or police officer, he was a volunteer!
(TALK ABOUT THE IMPORTANCE OF

VOLUNTEERS – HAVE THEM TO STAND - APPLAUD THEM)

At one point the man in the red bandana was seen carrying an injured woman on his back and leading a group of people to safety!

Two women who were rescued by the man in the red bandana at separate times that fateful day were Judy Wein and Ling Young! Wein said, *"I saw this incredible hero, running back and forth and saving the day, in his mind, he had a duty to do -- to save people."* Ling Young said, *"He's definitely my guardian angel -- no ifs, ands, or buts -- because without him, we would be sitting there, waiting until the building came down,"* **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

The man in the red bandana was obviously driven by a sense of urgency. He knew a lot of people were going to perish and time meant lives!

I want to say how much I appreciate those of you who consistently give to the work of the ministry and are fully engaged in the outreach efforts of this church, because time means souls. You are in a church today that is actively and passionately engaged in the people business!

(My story about the Juarez city dump – “*I did not call you to be a missionary, I called you to build a great missions church.*”)

The heartbeat of God is the salvation of the lost: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The duty of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The responsibility of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The business of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The activity of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The privilege of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The joy of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The reward of the Church is reaching the lost...

The man in the red bandana turned out to be Welles Crowther! On that fateful morning Welles made one final call to his mother Allison from his office at 9:12 a.m., minutes after his tower was struck, leaving a brief,

calm message saying, *"Mom, this is Welles. I want you to know that I'm OK."*

That call was all the Crowther's knew about their son's final moments until police knocked on their door months later. Allison said the New York medical examiner's office told them *"Welles' body had been found intact, with no signs of burns, alongside firefighters and emergency workers who had been running a command center in the South Tower's lobby and they were killed as the building collapsed."*

(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)

Authorities speculated, according to Allison, that Welles was aiding the rescue effort as a civilian volunteer usher when he died.

Welles worked in the business of rescue until he died. Rescue is the constant pattern of Gods activity! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

There is no discharge in this business of rescue!

The only fulfillment in life is in Christ and doing His will – rescuing the perishing and caring for the dying is the highest order and privilege of man! All the changes we have made, are making, will make are about a rescue effort!

There are souls who will be eternally lost if we do not step up to the plate and continue doing our part to rescue them! Every change we make is to improve our serve and to enhance the rescue effort!

A life of action produces a legacy of achievement! (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)

(Story of J.C. Mitchell)

Jude the half-brother of Jesus viewed the work of evangelism in the same way Welles viewed the rescue effort on that infamous day in September of 2001! Jude 1:22-23 (KJV) *“Of some have compassion, making a difference: ²³And others save with fear, pulling them out of the fire; hating even the garment spotted by the flesh.”*

Jude describes the work of evangelism with words like: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Have compassion...
- Make a difference...
- Save with fear...

- Pull them out of the fire...
- Hate the garment spotted by the flesh...

(Story of Larry Collins' house on fire –
Daughter Sherry)

Who are you personally involved with for
the expressed purpose of rescue? The
constant activity of God is rescue! Is that
the consistent pattern of our:

- Personal life?
- Professional life?
- Ministry life?
- Church life?

Just being involved in rescue through tithes
and offerings and sporadic church
attendance is not enough! As Christ
followers we must be actively involved in

personal rescue at all times! Money, people and time are of the essence.

CONCLUSION:

The servants heart: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME – LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)**

- Cares more than some think is wise...
- Risks more than some think is safe...
- Dreams more than some think is practical...
- Expects more than some think is possible...

If Welles gave his life to rescue total strangers and sacrificed his life in a rescue effort what do you think our responsibility is to this community?

If Jesus gave His sinless life and shed His precious blood for sinners, what do you think our responsibility is to the lost around this world?